

The Gentlemen Ransomware: Defense Evasion TTPs

Huntress SOC analysts investigated two incidents involving The Gentlemen ransomware, a RaaS operation that emerged in mid-2025 and has claimed over 400 victims across 70+ countries. The threat actors employed Scheduled Tasks, PowerShell-based AV tampering, log clearing, and a SOCKS proxy C2 implant disguised as svchost.exe to evade defenses and deploy file encryption. A leaked internal database provided additional insight into the group's tooling and tracked CVEs.

Threat Actors Identified

Actor	Aliases	Attribution Confidence
The Gentlemen	—	A2

Kill Chain Coverage

Reconnaissance	Weaponization	Delivery	Exploitation	Installation	C2	Actions
		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Techniques Observed (14)

T1078	T1021.001	T1053.005	T1562.001	T1070.001	T1059.001	T1036.005	T1090.001
T1486	T1548	T1484.001	T1543	T1105	T1202		

Business Impact Assessment

Financial Exposure

\$50,000 - \$5,000,000

Operational Impact

Ransomware encryption of business-critical files causes operational downtime across shipping/transportation and construction sectors; SOCKS proxy persistence enables sustained attacker dwell time even after initial remediation attempts.

Regulatory Exposure

Clearing of Security, System, and Application event logs may constitute destruction of evidence relevant to breach notification requirements under GDPR, HIPAA, or sector-specific regulations; failure to detect and report ransomware incidents could trigger regulatory penalties.

Recommended Board Actions

- Mandate multi-factor authentication (MFA) on all remote access including RDP and VPN, and restrict RDP exposure to the internet.
- Invest in 24/7 MDR/SOC coverage with pre-incident EDR deployment to ensure telemetry is available from the start of an attack, not after the fact.
- Establish an incident response retainer and test backup restoration procedures regularly to minimize ransomware recovery time and reduce likelihood of ransom payment.

Sectors Targeted

Shipping and Transportation

Construction

Geographies Targeted

Global (70+ countries)

Indicators of Compromise

5 indicators extracted. Full IoC list available in the Tactical report or via `GET /v1/iocs`.